CLASS 8 — ENGLISH GULMOHAR · HARD LEVEL UNIT TEST SET 3

Chapters 9–12: **The Boy Who Broke the Bank, The Visitor (from The Book Thief), Helen Keller (poem) - Langston Hughes, The Stolen Bacillus** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 2 Hours Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 50**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–15 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 16–20 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 21–25 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 26–27 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 24–25 and Q. 26–27.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 15 × 1 = 15

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. The poem's brevity best matches the idea that: 1

(a) brevity is weakness **(b)** a long poem is better
(c) strength needs no ornament **(d)** poets avoid detail

2. Which of the following best explains why Minnie's chase is called a 'secondary' action? 1

(a) It has no characters
(b) It ends the story
(c) It does not affect the main chase but drives comedy
(d) It is the main plot

3. Choose the sentence that is correctly punctuated: 1

(a) "We want it now" chanted, the people! **(b)** We want it now! chanted the people.
(c) "We want it now", chanted the people **(d)** "We want it now!" chanted the people.

4. Choose the correct sentence with a past perfect and past simple: 1

(a) By the time Rosa opened the door, Papa warns Max.
(b) By the time Rosa opened the door, Papa had warned Max.
(c) By the time Rosa opens the door, Papa had warned Max.
(d) By the time Rosa had opened the door, Papa warn Max.

5. 'Loveliness' found 'within herself' counters the belief that: 1

(a) poets are wise **(b)** beauty is rare
(c) beauty fades daily **(d)** beauty is only outward

6. Which of these is a theme that can be drawn from the story? 1

(a) Wives should not interrupt
(b) Fear based on false belief can be comic and foolish
(c) Cabmen are dishonest
(d) Cholera is harmless

7. 'Others insisted that he had fled the country.' The word 'insisted' suggests that those people were: 1

(a) well informed **(b)** joking
(c) stubborn about a belief without proof **(d)** hesitant

8. Extract: 'The sky, she noticed, was utterly blue. Not even the suggestion of a cloud.' The effect is to: 1

(a) contrast the calm sky with Liesel's inner turmoil
(b) prove it is summer
(c) describe a battle
(d) show the weather forecast

9. The poet's repeated use of 'found' suggests discovery as: 1

(a) a gift from strangers **(b)** an accident
(c) an active, personal achievement **(d)** a loss

10. The phrase 'ring him in' (para 10) is an image of: 1

(a) painting the germ **(b)** inviting the germ
(c) containing the germ before it spreads **(d)** listening to the germ

11. What is the writer satirising? 1

(a) police inefficiency only **(b)** bankers' honesty
(c) human gullibility and love of gossip **(d)** the hill towns

12. Which inference about Max's scissors is best supported by paras 68-69? 1

(a) He was ready to defend himself but felt guilty about it
(b) He wanted to attack the family
(c) He wanted to cut his hair
(d) He used them on the officer

13. Which reading of 'many' is most reasonable? 1

(a) people with sight who may lack insight **(b)** only sleeping people
(c) her relatives only **(d)** Nobel winners

14. The sentence 'He had only to break the little tube into the water supply' conveys the Anarchist's: 1

(a) belief that his plan was simple and grand
(b) love of water
(c) fear of the tube
(d) ignorance of cholera

15. 'Neither the Seth nor the clerks ___ at the bank that day' (correct choice): 1

(a) has been **(b)** is **(c)** were **(d)** was

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 5 × 2 = 10

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

16. How does a compact form make the message more forceful? 2

17. What does para 32 tell us about the Bacteriologist's lab practice? 2

18. Why is Faiz Hussain's customer called 'elderly gentleman', and what does it add? 2

19. What is the effect of the writer using italics for Liesel's thoughts? 2

20. How does the poem use symbolism rather than description to praise Keller? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 5 × 3 = 15

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

21. Discuss how the poem links inner vision with social responsibility. 3

22. Discuss the irony in the visitor's polite thanks in para 16. 3

23. Write about the effect of the short final paragraph. 3

24. Evaluate: 'Papa's calmness is stronger than Rosa's sharpness.' Do you agree? 3

OR

Analyse the importance of rhythm and line-length in the poem. 3

25. Discuss 'The Stolen Bacillus' as a comedy of errors. 3

OR

Pick out two examples of understatement or dry humour from the story and comment. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

26. Read: 'Mischief-makers, who did not have a paisa in the bank, joined the crowd. The manager stood at the door and tried to calm his angry customers.' 5

(a) Who are mischief-makers?
(b) Why did they join?
(c) Which word shows the manager's role?
(d) Tone of the sentence?
(e) What does it show about crowds?

OR

'The Hubermanns seem to lead two different lives.' Complete a contrast between what the world sees and what is actually happening. 5

27. Compare 'light' in stanza one and 'loveliness' in stanza two; how do they build towards the 'dower'? 5

OR

Write a critical appreciation of the story. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 50 Marks

MASTERMIND